

Ufuk Kızılgedik

Istanbul, Turkey |

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SUMMARY

Consumer insights leader with more than 5 years at Ipsos across quantitative, qualitative, and digital research. Combines classical market research training in brand health tracking, creative testing, and survey design with digital conversation analysis and hands-on data work in Python. Currently leads a team of 4 and a portfolio of 20+ client accounts across FMCG, retail and e-commerce, consumer electronics, banking, and tobacco, scoping research programs end to end and presenting findings to marketing leadership and C-suite audiences. Graduate training in sociology and quantitative methods at Brown University.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Ipsos Türkiye, Istanbul

Senior Research Manager & Team Lead | Jan 2025 – Present

Research Manager & Team Lead | Nov 2023 – Dec 2024

Research Manager | Jan 2023 – Oct 2023

- Lead consumer insight programmes for a portfolio of ~20 client accounts per year across FMCG, retail & e-commerce, consumer electronics, banking, and tobacco - covering brand health tracking, competitive intelligence, category deep-dives, campaign evaluation, and crisis & issues monitoring.
- Grew the team from 2 to 4 researchers and lead it day to day: allocating work, setting analytical standards, reviewing outputs, and training junior staff. Serve as Ipsos Turkey's internal subject-matter expert on social listening methodology, advising other departments on building digital data into wider research programmes.
- Scope, design, and price research programmes end to end — authored 50+ proposals over the past three years, converting into 10+ commissioned studies, including multi-phase programmes where digital analysis generates the hypotheses later tested through qualitative and quantitative stages.
- Integrate multiple evidence sources into single decision-ready narratives (for example, combining a national quantitative food-behaviour study with a digital trend report to produce one consolidated category outlook for an FMCG client).
- Present findings and recommendations directly to client marketing teams, including C-level audiences, translating analysis into decisions on brand positioning, campaign development, communications strategy, and crisis response.
- Use Python to work with large conversation datasets and automate recurring reporting, cutting turnaround on repeat deliverables and improving consistency across the team's outputs.
- Developed standardised reporting templates, measurement frameworks, and KPI definitions now used across the team; routinely audit how client metrics are calculated and flag where a standard measure misrepresents what the underlying data actually shows.

Senior Project Executive — Creative Excellence & Brand Health Tracking | Jul 2021 – Dec 2022

- Ran quantitative creative and ad testing projects and brand health tracking studies using Ipsos proprietary methodologies, managing fieldwork, data processing, and statistical analysis.
- Built hands-on expertise in survey design, sampling, significance testing, and normative benchmarking.
- Contributed to qualitative components including focus groups and in-depth interviews, translating consumer feedback into creative optimization recommendations.

Digital Strategy Manager

Bukafa Medya | Istanbul, Turkey | Aug 2020 - Jun 2021

- Developed digital content and social media strategies for brand clients, using audience and competitive analytics to guide platform and content planning.

EDUCATION

Master of Arts (M.A.), Sociology

Brown University | Providence, RI, USA | 2014 - 2016

- Continued into the doctoral program in sociology at Brown through 2018, completing full PhD coursework in quantitative and qualitative research methods, statistics, and research design.

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), Sociology

Bogazici University | Istanbul, Turkey | 2007 - 2011

High School Diploma

Robert College | Istanbul, Turkey | 2002 - 2007

SKILLS

Research Methods: Brand Health Tracking, Creative and Ad Testing, Survey Design, Sampling and Significance Testing, Qualitative Research (Focus Groups, In-Depth Interviews), Multi-Method Program Design

Consumer and Digital Analytics: Social Listening, Online Conversation Analysis, Sentiment Analysis, Audience and Influencer Analysis, Competitive Intelligence, Trend Forecasting

Tools and Platforms: Synthesio, Talkwalker, BoomSonar, Python, Tableau, Microsoft Excel, SPSS, Stata

Professional: Team Leadership, Client Management, Research Scoping and Budgeting, Data-Driven Storytelling, Stakeholder Presentation

Languages: Turkish (Native), English (Fluent)